



A knowledge initiative by MIT students and alumni

To whom it may concern:

Shaswata Shaha successfully finished the summer 2015 workshop by KolpoKoushol, an initiative led and run by Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) students and alumni. The MIT group who came to Bangladesh to mentor him were quite pleased with his performance. He was selected in the final participants group (of 60 students) to join the workshop, competing with a pool of 400 applicants from the whole nation.

The workshop was an intense six days long training program where students were taught some advanced concepts in computer science, mechanical engineering, technical product management, and product design concepts. They were given a few design and coding assignments every day and were also asked to materialize a challenging final project concept of their choice. Shaswata was very diligent in finishing the assignments given to him, and displayed an amazing level of competency and hard work in completing a final project.

Shaswata's final project was called VIRTRACC, in which he and his team developed an augmented reality based software system to aid city planners in monitoring traffic and controlling crowd flow. The system uses an overhead camera to track a few blocks placed on a paper map, and simulates traffic flow on the map, guided by the blocks placed physically. This was accomplished by his team in a matter of two days. Shaswata wrote most of the code to accomplish this task. He taught himself how to use OpenCV with Python within this period with amazing determination. We particularly noticed his creativity and patience in solving different design problems while tackling this project. He learned harder concepts fast and was ready to implement them right away.

I earnestly hope that he achieves success in his future creative endeavors. A talented, motivated, and enthusiastic student like him deserves to excel in the future. If you have any query about my mentorship experience with him, I will be glad to answer. Please do not hesitate to contact me in the following email address.

Sincerely,

Nazmus Saquib
Founder and Director, KolpoKoushol
Graduate Student, MIT Media Lab
saquib@mit.edu